Pip's Christmas Countdown

A Story Coloring Book for Toddlers - 25 Nights to Christmas + 25 Bonus Winter Adventures - 50 Big & Easy Pages, Ages 2-5

The story

A tiny star falls onto Pip's nose and plays hide-and-seek with him every night until Christmas. Kids hunt for Little Star on every page; on Christmas morning she appears on top of Pip's tree. In the bonus pages the friends keep playing through winter, until Little Star flies home and promises to come back next Christmas (sequel hook). Each caption is read aloud by a parent; every page ends with: **Can you find Little Star?**

Characters (all original)

Pip: a little round penguin with a big knitted scarf and a pom-pom hat
Little Star: a tiny smiling star who fell from the sky and hides on every page
Rosie: a baby reindeer
Bo: a polar bear cub
Hops: a bunny
Hoot: an owl
Fern: a fox cub
Biscuit: a puppy
Nutmeg: a squirrel

Front and back pages

This book belongs to page | **My Countdown Tracker**: 25 stars, color one each night | **Letter to Santa** page | **Christmas Coloring Champion** certificate (last page)

Part 1: 25 Nights to Christmas

Day 1	A little star tumbled right onto Pip's nose. "Find me each day till Christmas!" And off Little Star goes!
Day 2	Pip built a snowman, round, jolly and tall. "Hello, Mister Snowman! You're the biggest of all!"
Day 3	"Dear Santa," wrote Pip, with his very best care, "please bring all my friends something cozy to wear!"
Day 4	Whoosh! Down the hill went Pip and Rosie the deer. "Again!" they both shouted. "Hold on! Steer, steer, STEER!"
Day 5	Pip found a small tree, as green as can be. He pulled it home slowly. "Come live here with me!"
Day 6	Shiny round ornaments went up one by one. Pip hung up the last one. "Look! Isn't this fun?"
Day 7	Pip looked at the treetop, so empty and bare. "Something is missing..." What could go up there?
Day 8	Bo helped Pip bake cookies, warm, golden and sweet. One cookie went missing... did Bo have a treat?
Day 9	Gumdrops and frosting and candy-cane beams. Pip built the gingerbread house of his dreams!
Day 10	Pip wrapped a present so giant and wide, he got himself tangled in ribbon inside!
Day 11	Hops the bunny glided across the ice. Pip wibbled and wobbled, then twirled once, then twice!
Day 12	SPLAT! Hoot's snowball landed right on Pip's hat. Pip laughed, "My turn now! Take that, and take that!"
Day 13	Pip hung up his stocking, all fuzzy and red. "I hope it gets full!" Pip happily said.
Day 14	Pip and his friends sang a song by the tree: la-la and toot-toot and a hoo-hoo-HEE!
Day 15	Hot cocoa with marshmallows, one, two, three. Pip blew on his mug. "Mmm, just right for me!"

Day 16	Fern the fox cub snipped paper with care. They made a long chain to hang everywhere!
Day 17	Choo-choo! The toy train went round and around. Pip waved from the top as it chugged on the ground!
Day 18	Pip and Rosie wore sweaters just the same. "We're twins!" Rosie giggled. "Let's make up a game!"
Day 19	Pip hung a big wreath on the door with pride. "Only six more sleeps!" he cheered from outside.
Day 20	Bo and Pip built a fort out of snow, with a door and a window and a flag on top. Go!
Day 21	Pip flopped in the snow and he flapped, flap, flap! He made a snow angel, then took a short nap.
Day 22	Cookies for Santa and milk for him too. "No nibbles, Bo!" giggled Pip. "These aren't for you!"
Day 23	In cozy pajamas, Pip peeked at the moon. "Is that a sleigh?" he whispered. "So soon?"
Day 24	Pip hugged his teddy and closed his eyes tight. "Little Star, where are you? Goodnight, goodnight."
Day 25	Merry Christmas! And look who's on top of the tree! Little Star! "The best gift is friends, you and me!"

Part 2: Winter Adventures with Pip & Little Star

Page 26	Pip juggled three ornaments, up, up so high. "Don't drop them!" laughed Little Star from nearby.
Page 27	Pip found a big mitten, warm as could be. He curled up inside it. "A bed just for me!"
Page 28	Bo gave Pip a ride on his big furry back. "Giddy-up, Bo!" Pip cheered down the track.
Page 29	One candy cane, two friends... what should they do? Hops snapped it in half. "One for me, one for you!"
Page 30	Pip pulled a sled piled high with gifts, up hills and down hills and over snowdrifts!
Page 31	Boom-boom! Rat-a-tat! Pip played on his drum. Everyone danced. Here they come, here they come!
Page 32	Pip planted a tree, just a sprout, oh so small. "Grow big," whispered Pip, "and be tallest of all!"
Page 33	Hoot read a story by soft lantern light. Pip snuggled closer. "Just one more tonight?"
Page 34	Pip found a Santa hat. Whoa, it's too big! It covered his eyes, so he danced a silly jig!
Page 35	Snowflakes were falling, so soft and so light. Pip caught them on his tongue. Yum, chilly and white!
Page 36	A puppy named Biscuit came bouncing to play. They rolled a big yarn ball all through the day!
Page 37	Pip peeked out of a snow globe, round and see-through. Shake, shake! The snow swirls. Now it's snowing on you!
Page 38	Pip tied a bow on Rosie's antler, so neat. "I look so pretty!" She stamped her feet.
Page 39	Pip and a kitten stacked presents up high. One more, and one more... it's touching the sky!
Page 40	Up in a balloon, Pip floated so high. "Hello, snowy hills! Hello, clouds in the sky!"

Page 41	Nutmeg the squirrel had a cupcake to share. "Half for you, Pip, because friends always care!"
Page 42	Pip rode a rocking horse, back and forth, too. "Giddy-up! Giddy-up! Where are we going? Woo-hoo!"
Page 43	Pip fished through the ice, so patient and still. A wiggle! A tug! Pip squealed with a thrill!
Page 44	Mama, Papa and Pip in a big squishy hug, warm as a blanket and cozy as a rug.
Page 45	Wheee! Down a giant candy cane Pip took a ride. "Again! Again!" he giggled. "The best Christmas slide!"
Page 46	Pip waved his baton, and the snowmen all swayed. The wiggliest music that ever was played!
Page 47	POP! Out of a box jumped Pip with a cheer. "Surprise!" laughed his friends. "We're SO glad you're here!"
Page 48	Fern and Pip toasted marshmallows, one, two. "Gooey and yummy! I saved one for you!"
Page 49	All of Pip's friends sat round in a ring. They told happy stories and started to sing.
Page 50	Little Star twinkled, "It's time to fly home. I'll be back next Christmas. You're never alone!"

Gemini prompt changes to match the story

Setup message: replace the hidden-star rule with: *Hide Little Star, a small five-point star with a tiny smiling face, somewhere on every page (medium size, easy for a child to find).*
Page 1: Pip looks cross-eyed and smiling at Little Star, a small smiling star sitting on the tip of his beak, snowflakes falling
Page 7: Pip on tiptoes looking up at a decorated Christmas tree with an empty top, a puzzled smile
Page 25: Pip and all his friends opening presents by the tree, Little Star big and smiling on top of the tree (not hidden on this page)
Page 50: Pip waving goodbye from in front of a cozy snowy house as Little Star flies up into the night sky